
Paper 3, Option 31: Rebellion and disorder under the Tudors, 1485–1603

Overview

This option comprises two parts: the *Aspects in breadth* focus on long-term changes and contextualise the *Aspects in depth*, which focus in detail on key episodes.

Together, the breadth and depth topics explore the nature of rebellion and disorder under the Tudors and the way the various challenges were met, the nature of change in government over the period and the changing relationship between the Crown and key sections of society. The option enables students to explore the way in which, despite a shaky start, the Tudors were able to establish their dynasty as one of the most powerful England has seen.

Aspects in breadth: controlling a fractious nation – changes in Tudor government, 1485–1603	
Themes	Content
1 Changes in governance at the centre	- Government and administration, 1485–1603, including changes made to structure and function of the household, changes in the role of Secretary, establishing the post of lord lieutenant (key development: reform of the Privy Council 1540). - Crown, church and parliament, 1485–1603: church-state relations, including the impact of the Reformation (key developments: the Acts of Supremacy of 1534 and 1559, the Elizabethan religious settlement); development of the concepts of sovereignty of statute and parliamentary privilege; the extent of change in the relationship between crown and parliament.
2 Gaining the cooperation of the localities	- Involving the localities in governance, 1485–1603: relations with localities (key developments: re-establishing the Council of the North 1537, the Law in Wales Acts 1535 and 1542); increasing borough representation in the Commons over the period; impact of increasing literacy in the yeoman class; the changing role of justices of the peace (key developments: the Tudor subsidy of 1513, the Statute of Artificers 1563, the Act for the Relief of the Poor 1598). - The crown and the country, 1485–1603: the development of a network of personal relationships by patronage, the granting of lands, titles and positions at court; the increasing use of royal progresses beyond London and the Home Counties.

Aspects in depth: challenges to authority	
Key topics	Content
1 Challenging the succession, 1485–1499	- Henry Tudor's hold on the throne, 1485–87: the impact of Bosworth 1485; measures to secure his throne; the roles of the Yorkist and Lancastrian factions. - The nature and extent of the challenges of Lambert Simnel, 1486–87, and Perkin Warbeck, 1491–99, and how they were overcome. - The significance of support for the challengers from Burgundy, France, Scotland and Ireland.
2 Challenging religious changes, 1533–37	- The impact of Henrician religious changes, 1533–37: the break with Rome and the dissolution of the monasteries. - The causes and impact of the Lincolnshire Rising and the Pilgrimage of Grace: aims, methods, nature of support and extent of threat. - The role of leaders in challenge and suppression: Robert Aske and Francis Bigod; Thomas Cromwell, Henry VIII and the Duke of Norfolk; the extent of repression in 1537.
3 Agrarian discontent: Kett's rebellion 1549	- The social and economic reasons for rebellion: the impact of enclosures; rural discontent; the impact of the Duke of Somerset's commission on enclosures. - The challenge posed by Kett's rebellion: its demands; extent of the threat posed. - The role of leaders in challenge and suppression: Kett; Somerset and the Earl of Warwick; the extent of repression.
4 Queen takes Queen? The revolt of the northern earls, 1569–70	- The causes of and development of the challenge: problem posed by Mary, Queen of Scots; court politics and faction; the role of the Duke of Norfolk; economic and religious insecurities of the northern nobility; Mary's arrival in 1568. - The main events of the revolt: the significance of the capture of Durham and the siege of Barnard Castle; the role of the northern earls; the extent of the threat to Elizabeth. - Failure and its impact: reasons for failure; repression; implications for Catholicism and Protestantism in England.
5 Troublesome Ireland: Tyrone's rebellion, 1594–1603	- The reasons for the Nine Years' War (Tyrone's rebellion) and the significance of the support for Hugh O'Neill and Hugh Roe O'Donnell from within Ireland and from Spain. - The significance of events and individuals: the Battles of Clontibret 1595, Yellow Ford 1598, Curlew Pass 1599, and the collapse of the Munster Plantation; the roles of Henry Baginbagen, Florence MacCarthy, the Earl of Essex and Lord Mountjoy. - Reasons for the war's duration and England's eventual success, including the battle of Kinsale 1601, the late arrival of Spanish support and the siege of Dunboy; costs to the English government.